HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I'm old and useless"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I'm old and useless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What do I know and have lived through that others could learn from?
- ☐ Who has asked for my advice or prayers?
- ☐ What could I give: time, listening, prayer, a skill?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the elderly?
- ☐ Who in my life is lonely and might welcome a call?
- ☐ What is one way to serve this week?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ I still bear fruit in old age.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown.
- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ My wisdom matters.
- ☐ I can pray for others.
- ☐ I am not useless.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ **Psalm 92:14**
  *"In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain."*
- ☐ **Proverbs 16:31**
  *"Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness."*
- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  *"Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."*

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still fruitful: Each week, note one way you encouraged or helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Psalm 92:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will still bear fruit in old age.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).*

- [ ] List what you offer. Write skills, stories, and wisdom.
- [ ] Call someone. Reach out to a person who may be lonely.
- [ ] Pray daily. Pray by name for family and friends.
- [ ] Mentor. Offer to share your experience with someone younger.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm old and useless": _____ %  My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | Still fruitful |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm old and useless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Father, You have promised to carry me in old age. Show me how to serve and bear fruit in this season. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*